

wealthy pupils. This suited his character, for he was a dandy with impeccable manners and also something of a social climber. He earned well, but spent most of his money maintaining an extravagant lifestyle appropriate to the circles in which he moved.



THE NOVEMBER UPRISING

This painting of the Polish rebellion against Russian rule is by Polish artist January Suchodolski, who fought in what became known as the November Uprising (1830–1831). The rebellion was brutally crushed by the superior Russian forces. For Chopin, this defeat meant that, as a Polish nationalist, he was prevented from returning to his native Poland. His yearning for his homeland, and deep dismay at the failure of the rebellion, is reflected in several of his works.

It was a lifestyle that brought Chopin into contact with many attractive young women. He had various tepid youthful romances (one of which ended with a broken engagement), but they were all overshadowed by